

Hariharan Vijay Iswaran

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Aspiring Security Engineer with an M.S. in Cybersecurity (3.90 GPA) and hands-on experience in threat detection, SIEM log analysis, and web application penetration testing. Proven ability to detect, exploit, and remediate vulnerabilities through hands-on projects, along with real-world endpoint security hardening experience managing 100+ production Linux workstations.

EDUCATION

<i>Master's in Cybersecurity</i> - University of North Carolina at Charlotte	GPA: 3.90 Aug 2024 – May 2026
<i>Bachelor's in Information Technology</i> - SRM Institute of Science and Technology, TN, India	GPA: 3.6 Sept 2020 – May 2024

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: C, Python, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Bash
Detection & Monitoring: SIEM (ELK Stack), KQL, Log Analysis, Threat Detection
Security Tools: Nmap, Netcat, Burp Suite, OWASP ZAP, Wireshark, Metasploit
Systems & Infrastructure: Linux, Windows, Active Directory, IAM, SSO, System Hardening

CERTIFICATIONS

- eJPTv2 Junior Penetration Tester
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect associate
- OSCP (in Progress)

EXPERIENCE

Technical Linux Specialist | ONEIT – UNCC Oct 2025 – May 2026

- **Endpoint Security Hardening & Automation:** 100+ workstations required migration off EOL Linux versions with inconsistent AWX/Ansible deployment reliability; audited NetBox/AWX records to track down unmanaged endpoints via IP and monitored deployments in real time to resolve failed package installs, bringing the full fleet into compliance standards through a reliable, repeatable secure-imaging pipeline.
- **Identity & Access Management:** Every reimaged and new workstation required correct access provisioning; managed user/admin access groups in Grouper, maintaining access control integrity across 100+ systems.
- **Asset Lifecycle Management:** Inventory audits revealed 25+ unused, unmanaged workstations posing unmonitored endpoint exposure; securely wiped and decommissioned them with full documentation.
- **Technical Support:** High weekly ticket volume (15+) required fast, reliable resolution; delivered Tier 1/2 support on-site and remotely via SSH across OS, network, and configuration issues.

PROJECTS

Threat Detection & Log Analysis (Endpoint, DNS, SSL, NetFlow) | Python, Kibana, KQL, Elastic SIEM Sep – Nov 2025

- Enterprise logs lacked built-in threat context; identified pass-the-hash attacks, DGA-based C2 domains, and forged SSL certificates using KQL queries and a custom Python enrichment pipeline, isolating compromised hosts and source IPs.
- NetFlow data showed no visibility into exfiltration risk; diagnosed 50MB+ data exfiltration and beaconing activity via Elastic SIEM analysis, validating findings across six separate log-based investigations.

Web Application Penetration Testing & Remediation | Java, Burp Suite, OWASP ZAP Sep – Nov 2025

- A live web application contained multiple unvalidated input vectors; exploited SQL injection, XSS, CSRF, SSRF, and IDOR vulnerabilities, achieving authentication bypass, credential theft, and unauthorized data access.
- Identified vulnerabilities required remediation; implemented parameterized queries, context-aware encoding, and session-based access control, then validated each fix by retesting and documented findings in formal pentest reports.

Enterprise Security Lab: IAM & Network Infrastructure | Ansible, LDAP, Kerberos, DNSSEC Feb – Apr 2025

- Built and automated a multi-container (LXD) enterprise lab from scratch using Ansible, deploying DNS, LDAP, Kerberos, SSO, and web servers with idempotency and error-checking built into every playbook. DNS and LDAP traffic was vulnerable to spoofing/interception and lacked passwordless authentication; secured it with DNSSEC-signed zones, a custom root CA, and LDAPS encryption, then deployed BIND9 with zone replication and Kerberos backed by OpenLDAP, enabling GSSAPI SSH-based passwordless SSO and extending the trust chain to a TLS-secured, LDAPS-integrated WordPress login.